SLIIT GAVEL CLUB EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE 2025 ONBOARDING MEETING MINUTES

Date: 09.10.2025
Duration: 02 Hours and 46 Minutes
Meeting Type: Executive Committee Onboarding
Chair: Gahana (President)

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The Executive Committee conducted a comprehensive onboarding session establishing strategic direction for the term. Key decisions include: (1) 1,000 LKR annual membership fee to fund club registration; (2) Installation ceremony scheduled for December with Sahasra as Chair and Kaveesha and Thusara as Assistant Chairs; (3) Multiple engagement initiatives launched including monthly book club, movie festival, and merchandising program.

ATTENDEES

Present: Gahana (President), Sahasra (VP Education), Pavan (VP Membership), Mahira (VP Public Relations), Dilni (Secretary), Rashaad (Treasurer), Sahnas (Sergeant-At-Arms), Malindu (Event Coordinator), Mihisha (Media Coordinator), Shamla (Asst. VP Education), Thusara (Asst. VP Membership), Savini (Asst. VP Public Relations), Abisheka (Asst. Secretary), Kaveesha (Asst. Treasurer), Apiram (Asst. Sergeant-At-Arms)

Total Attendees: 15 members

KEY DECISIONS

Financial

D-1: Annual Membership Fee

- **Decision:** 1,000 LKR annual fee approved
- **Rationale:** Fund Gavel Sri Lanka registration, create member commitment, cover 32+ meetings annually
- **Owner:** Rashaad (Treasurer)

D-2: Bank Account Creation

- **Decision:** Establish club bank account (Commercial Bank)
- **Estimated Deposit:** 10,000-25,000 LKR minimum
- **Owner:** Rashaad (Treasurer)

Events & Programming

D-3: Installation Ceremony

- **When:** December
- **Leadership:** Sahasra (Chair), Kaveesha (Assistant Chair), Thusara (Assistant Chair)
- **Venue:** SLIIT auditorium
- **Partner:** Pay&Go as official sponsor

D-4: Open House

- **Chair:** Mahira (VP Public Relations)
- **Deadline:** Date to be finalized by next Monday
- **Target:** 50-100 attendees, convert 25 to members
- **Theme:** Impromptu speaking/Y-Bar showcase

D-5: Meeting Schedule

- **Decision:** Maintain weekend meetings (weekday conflicts identified)
- **Status:** Exact day/time pending finalization by Sahasra

D-6: Outdoor Meeting

- **Format:** Day-out (11 votes) vs overnight (9 votes)
- **Decision:** Day-out with optional overnight extension
- **Co-Chairs:** Dilni (Secretary) and Malindu (Event Coordinator)

New Initiatives

D-7: Book Club

- **Frequency:** Monthly, online format initially
- **First Book:** "No Longer Human" (82 pages)
- **Co-Chairs:** Sahasra (VP Education) and Kaveesha (Asst. Treasurer)
- **Structure:** Members vote on future selections

D-8: Movie Festival

- **Timeline:** Post-exams
- **Format:** Registration/ticketing (~100 rupees)
- **Lead:** Mahira (VP Public Relations)

D-9: Merchandising

- **Items:** T-shirts, pins, stickers
- **Coordinator:** Rashaad (Treasurer)
- **Process:** Poll for design preferences

D-10: Shadow Committee

- **Process:** Google Form applications

- **Committees:** Education, Membership, PR, Sergeant-at-Arms
- **Requirement:** Applicants must be members

D-11: Joint Meetings

- **Target:** Minimum 3 joint meetings
- **Partners:** CA Sri Lanka, USJ, UOC

D-12: Keynote Speaker Series

- **Frequency:** Every meeting
- **Coordinator:** Education team

D-13: Meeting Format

- **Structure:** Standard four-segment Toastmasters format
- **Time Limits:** Evaluators: 2-3 min for speeches, 1 min for table topics

PRIORITY ACTION ITEMS

High Priority

ID	Action	Owner	Due Date	Status
AI-1	Finalize Open House date	Mahira	Next Monday	Assigned
AI-2	Create shadow committee Google Form	Gahana/Pavan	Next day	Assigned
AI-3	Plan Installation ceremony	Sahasra, Kaveesha, Thusara	December	Assigned
AI-4	Complete bank account creation	Rashaad	ASAP	In Progress
AI-5	Implement 1,000 LKR fee collection	Rashaad, Dilni	Before next meeting	Assigned

ID	Action	Owner	Due Date	Status
AI-6	Create testimonial videos + film 6 PR scripts	Mahira, Mihisha	Ongoing	In Progress
AI-7	Document recruitment barriers for Open House	Pavan	Before Open House	Assigned
AI-8	Coordinate Open House logistics	Malindu, Dilni	Before Open House	Assigned
AI-9	Develop Open House agenda	Mahira	2-3 weeks before	Assigned
AI-10	Create Open House promotional materials	Mahira	2-3 weeks before	Assigned
AI-11	Finalize meeting schedule	Sahasra	Within 1 week	Assigned
AI-12	Develop CC/CL tracking system	Sahasra	Within 2 weeks	Assigned
AI-13	Coordinate keynote speaker for next meeting	Shamla/Hiranya	Before next meeting	Assigned
AI-14	Self-educate on Toastmasters procedures	All Exco	Ongoing	Assigned

Medium Priority

ID	Action	Owner	Due Date
AI-15	Contact CA Sri Lanka for Halloween joint meeting	Gahana	ASAP
AI-16	Reach out to UOC (contact: Lavan)	Sahasra	TBD
AI-17	Finalize outdoor meeting logistics	Dilni, Malindu	TBD
AI-18	Create t-shirt preference poll	Savini	Next day
AI-19	Coordinate t-shirt printing	Rashaad	TBD
AI-20	Create book club flyer	Sahasra, Kaveesha	Tomorrow
AI-21	Read book and plan meeting structure	Sahasra, Kaveesha	1 month
AI-22	Plan movie festival logistics	Mahira	Post-exams
AI-23	Arrange Open House keynote speaker	Gahana/Mahira	2 weeks before
AI-24	Promote the Open House event across faculties	Mahira/Pavan	2 weeks before
AI-25	Sign MOU with IEEE	Gahana/Pavan	ASAP
AI-26	Create short-form video content (20-30 sec)	Mahira	Ongoing

TERM GOALS & STRATEGIC MISSIONS

Mission 1: Consistent Meetings

- Build Exco capacity to run meetings independently
- Address last term's inconsistency due to insufficient role players

Mission 2: Creative & Themed Meetings

- Move beyond standard format with themes and creativity

- Philosophy: "If you're already having fun, definitely they will learn something"

Mission 3: Member Growth & Retention

- Current challenge: Only 5-6 returning members despite 30 new members
- Focus on CC/CL pathway completion (10 speeches for CC, 10 roles for CL)
- VP Membership responsible for tracking and retention

Mission 4: Financial Sustainability

- Annual fee creates commitment through payment
- Establish sustainable funding model

CLUB VISION & CULTURE

Core Principles:

- **Positivity:** No criticism or negative impact on members
- **Purpose-Driven:** Clear roles and meeting objectives
- **Safe Space:** Drama-free environment
- **Educational Mission:** Develop public speaking skills, not just entertainment

Quote: "The mission of Gavel is to make sure that as undergraduates... you can speak. For example, if I put Pavan down in a stage and give him a mic, he can handle the crowd for an hour or two."

TOASTMASTERS CORE VALUES

- **Respect:** Stop immediately if someone expresses discomfort
- **Excellence:** Give 100% to assigned responsibilities; communicate updates proactively
- **Integrity & Service:** Trust-based delegation

EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE ROLES

President (Gahana): Vision planning, strategic guidance, coordinating initiatives

VP Education (Sahasra): Meeting organization (dates, agendas, roles), contest organization, pathway tracking

VP Membership (Pavan): Member retention (primary), recruitment (secondary), attendance tracking

VP Public Relations (Mahira): Promotional materials, visibility campaigns, team coordination

Secretary (Dilni): Constitution management, meeting minutes, record-keeping, financial tracking support

Treasurer (Rashaad): Bank account management, membership fee collection, financial reporting

Sergeant-at-Arms (Sahnas): Asset management, logistics, meeting space booking, technical setup

Event Coordinator (Malindu): Special events, hall booking, contest support

Media Coordinator (Mihisha): PR support, network partnerships, website maintenance

Coverage Strategy: Minimum 80% attendance expected; assistants cover when VPs absent

PR STRATEGY & MEMBER PERCEPTION

Problems Identified

1. Seniors perceive Gavel as "boring... just meetings where we come and speak"
2. Misconception: "It's for people who can already speak"
3. Fear barrier: People scared of being forced to speak

Solutions Approved

1. Showcase differentiators (event hosting/MCing capabilities)

2. Create content showing member improvement, not just meeting recaps
3. Rebrand as learning platform: "You come to Gavel to learn public speaking, to improve"
4. Short-form video content (20-30 second reels) for social media

OPEN HOUSE STRUCTURE

Purpose: Mini-meeting showcasing club offerings to prospective members

Structure:

- Welcome address
- Engaging icebreaker
- Introduction to Gavel
- Meeting roles overview
- CC/CL pathways introduction
- Keynote speech
- "Why join Gavel" segment
- Membership sign-up

Goals:

- 50-100 prospective attendees
- Convert 25 into regular members
- Pitch 1,000 LKR membership during event

Timeline Challenges:

- IT faculty exams end of October
- Mid-November conflicts with exam period
- Members leave campus after exams

UNRESOLVED ITEMS

1. **Open House Date** - Awaiting Mahira's decision by next Monday
2. **Exact Weekend Meeting Schedule** - Day and time to be finalized by Sahasra
3. **T-Shirt Design** - Pending poll results and PR team submissions
4. **PR Video Filming Dates** - 6 scripts need filming; scheduling coordination ongoing
5. **Partnerships** - University of Jaffna and Uva Wellassa University status unclear

CRITICAL CLARIFICATION REQUIRED

CQ-1: Open House Timing Conflict Given exam period constraints, what is the realistic timeframe? Before exams (lower attendance) or after exams (lost momentum)?

CQ-2: Book Club Content Appropriateness "No Longer Human" contains themes of suicide, depression, and child abuse. Has content been reviewed for appropriateness? Should trigger warnings be included?

CQ-3: Installation Ceremony Budget What is the confirmed budget and Pay&Go sponsorship amount?

CQ-4: Bank Account Deposit What is the confirmed minimum deposit requirement from Commercial Bank?

CULTURAL & OPERATIONAL EXPECTATIONS

1. **Professional Conduct:** Avoid internal conflicts or factions within Exco
2. **Conflict Resolution:** Problems resolved internally; chair available for mediation
3. **Communication Standards:** Clear communication for absences with advance notice
4. **Volunteer Ethos:** "This is volunteer work, not paid employment; goal is giving back to community while gaining personal development"

5. **Member Encouragement:** Complete speeches within 2-3 weeks, take meeting roles, seek mentorship

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